significantly exacerbated by Pakistani involvement, refrain from launching a conventional attack on Pakistan? The answer indubitably must be attributed to their mutual possession of nuclear weapons. As General Krishnaswami Sundarji, a former chief of staff of the Indian Army, stated in a widely publicized interview, “Any sensible planner sitting on this side of the border is going to assume that Pakistan does indeed have a nuclear weapons capability. And by the same token, I rather suspect that the view from the other side is going to look very similar.”[32]

Similar evidence about the role of nuclear weapons in preventing an outbreak of war can also be adduced from the Pakistani side. As a former chief of staff of the Pakistan Army, General Mirza Afzal Beg, stated in an interview, “We have no fear of war; [this lack of fear] has been possible because [of] nuclear deterrence which exists today on the subcontinent.” Furthermore, he contended that “the fear of retaliation lessens the likelihood of war between India and Pakistan. I can assure you that if there was no such fear we would have probably gone to war in 1990.” [33]

Finally, K. Subrahmanyam, India’s noted strategic affairs analyst, made the most telling argument about the role of nuclear weapons in the 1990 crisis. As he wrote:

> The awareness on both sides of a nuclear capability that can enable either country to assemble nuclear weapons at short notice induces mutual caution. This caution is already evident on the part of India. In 1965 when Pakistan carried out Operation Gibraltar and sent in infiltrators, India sent its army across the cease-fire line to destroy the assembly points of the infiltrators. That escalated into a full-scale war. In 1990 when Pakistan once again carried out a massive infiltration of terrorists trained in Pakistan, India tried to deal with the problem on Indian territory and did not send its army into Pakistan-occupied Kashmir.[34]

To sum up the argument: despite substantial conventional military capabilities and significant pressure in the form of public opinion, India chose not to resort to military action against Pakistan during